

Kognize — Session Report

Date: 2026-07-09

Team: Product Manager, Frontend Dev, Backend Dev, DevOps

HEAD at end of session: 86c9e9f (6 commits ahead of origin/main, pending push via Xcode Integrate)

1. Summary

This was the first full working session on Kognize. It covered two tracks: setting up how the team (Claude Code, operating as four personas) works with Kya, and building out the app itself — from an empty Xcode template to a navigable app with a real lock screen, a dashboard, goals, a chat stub, and a working theme system. Nothing talks to a backend yet; everything is frontend-only with static or in-memory data, by design, matching the build order's “build the fake-data version fully before connecting anything real.”

2. Team & process set up today

- **CLAUDE.md merged into main.** It existed only on an unmerged branch at the start of the session — now it's active context for every session going forward.
- **Four-persona team formalized:** Product Manager (new today), Frontend Dev, Backend Dev, DevOps. PM is the default addressee, breaks down and delegates work, and is the most vocal voice back to Kya. All four speak as separate, clearly labeled voices in every response.
- **Reporting format locked in:** unified pros/cons list per task, tagged by which persona raised each point; a short “what broke / how it was fixed / result” write-up only when something actually broke.
- **PM owns committing (and attempting to push)** after every significant step. Push from this session always fails — no GitHub credentials are reachable here, confirmed repeatedly. Kya pushes from his end via **Xcode's Source Control** → **Integrate**, confirmed working mid-session.
- **PM owns cost/spend monitoring** once the project has a real backend and real infrastructure costs — explicitly dormant today, since everything is still free-tier/local.
- Looked into AI-usage-percentage monitoring — not technically possible from this session. Agreed instead: Kya shares his usage number when he checks it, PM cross-references against 50/70/90% milestones.

3. What got built

3.1 Core app shell (Build Order Step 1)

- Removed the default Xcode/SwiftData template.
- **Disclaimer splash** — educational-only / read-only copy, single acknowledgment, no skip.
- **Unified unlock screen** — passcode keypad is the primary, always-visible method; Face ID attempts automatically in the background on appear, shown as a small status icon near the top. Biometrics-only policy, so a Face ID failure never triggers iOS's own system passcode sheet on top of the custom keypad.
- **Passcode keypad** — 4-digit, numeric buttons shuffle position on every appearance and after every wrong attempt; Delete fixed bottom-left, Enter fixed bottom-right. Green/red glow on the 4 dots and the true screen edge on submit. Infinite attempts, no lockout, per Kya's call for now. Hardcoded to 1234 — no persistence yet.
- **Privacy overlay** — full-screen black cover whenever the app isn't in the foreground. Backgrounding also resets the flow back to the disclaimer screen.

3.2 Main navigation

- **Bottom tab bar:** Dashboard, Ask Kog, Goals, Journal.
- **Floating hamburger menu** (top-right, fixed everywhere): Profile, Connected Accounts, App Security, Notifications, Themes, Subscription, Send Feedback — plus a red pill “Log Out” button.
- Established rule: any screen-level action button goes top-left, never top-right, since the hamburger always owns that corner.

3.3 Dashboard

- Reorderable, removable widget list (native SwiftUI List edit mode, custom “Edit Dashboard” button).
- Widgets: Score, Kog's 3-line summary, Spending, Income, Score History (+N deltas), Investments (quick-add sheet), Accounts.
- Time-based greeting header (“Good afternoon, Kya”) with today's date.
- Every widget taps into a shared WidgetDetailView template instead of a bespoke screen per metric.
- All values are static placeholders — real data arrives with the backend/Kog scoring endpoint.

3.4 Goals

- 3-step MCQ creation flow: type (Savings, Debt Reduction, or Emergency Fund — a first-class type so the health score can read it like any other goal), then minimal required fields, then an optional Advanced step.
- Goal list shows a progress bar per goal; detail view includes a Kog's-take blurb.

3.5 Ask Kog

- Real chat bubbles, staggered bouncing-dots typing indicator, auto-scroll. No AI connected yet — always replies with a static “Hello world” line after ~1.2s, proving out the UI ahead of the real endpoint.

3.6 Journal (merged with Spending Context)

- Segmented screen: Entries (free-text, timestamped) and Spending Context — a multiple-choice “what's stressing your spending” prompt, categories grounded in real 2025 survey data, plus free-text Other.
- This is the master plan's “Context input” feature, made concrete — meant to feed Kog's chat context once that layer exists.

3.7 Menu screens

- **Profile** — name/email fields, Change Passcode entry point (placeholder), Sign Out.
- **Notifications** — Daily Digest toggle with a real time picker (defaults 8pm), Score/Goal/Spending alert toggles.
- **Themes** — genuinely functional (see below).
- **Send Feedback** — real screen: category picker, free-text field, submit with local confirmation. Frontend-only, and says so.
- Connected Accounts, App Security, Subscription remain placeholders (no dead ends).

3.8 Theming — built twice, second time for real

- First pass: settings UI only, nothing functional, by design at the time.
- Second pass, at Kya's request: fully functional. ThemeManager (@Observable singleton) holds accent + appearance mode, persisted via UserDefaults. Color.kognizePurple is now a computed property reading live from the manager. Color.kognizeBackground is a real adaptive color.
- Fixed a real bug: sheets don't reliably pick up a live .preferredColorScheme change from an ancestor — each sheet root now declares the modifier itself.

- Added `Color.darkened(by:)` and `Color.kognizeAccentDark` — a solid, darker version of the selected accent, used for the hamburger icon and the passcode keypad's digit/delete glyphs.
- Text color rule established and swept app-wide: actual text is always `.primary` (white in dark, black in light), never dimmed or tinted; `.secondary` reserved for icon-only glyphs. Converted ~18 files, fixed List section header defaults, caught and fixed a `PrivacyOverlay` bug this surfaced.

3.9 Xcode / tooling fix

- Fixed a corrupted `AppIcon.appiconset/Contents.json` (dangling dark/tinted slots with no image assigned) that was making Xcode's asset catalog editor report as empty/broken.

4. Known limitations / not done yet

- No backend exists (build order steps 2–5 not started).
- Nothing persists across relaunch except theme choice — goals, journal entries, chat, spending context, dashboard layout all reset every launch. Biggest thing worth prioritizing next.
- Ask Kog has no real intelligence — static reply only.
- Passcode is hardcoded (1234), not hashed, not stored in Keychain.
- Light mode hasn't been visually verified — no simulator access from this session.
- App icon has an alpha channel — will need flattening before real App Store submission.
- Account creation / sign-in (multi-device sync) flagged by Kya for a later phase.
- Push always fails from this session (no reachable GitHub credentials) — Kya pushes via Xcode's Integrate.

5. Repo state at end of session

- 6 commits sitting on local main, ahead of origin/main, pending your next Integrate.
- Working tree clean — nothing uncommitted.
- Worth a glance next time you're in Xcode: mid-session there was evidence of your own Xcode/Integrate activity landing in this same synced working directory (an app-icon change you were making) — nothing on our end touched it directly, but worth confirming it looks how you left it.

6. Suggested next steps (for discussion tomorrow)

- Persistence — pick a starting point (Keychain for the passcode; local storage or a real backend for goals/journal/chat).
- Or: start Build Order Step 2 (backend scaffold) so aggregator/Kog work can begin in parallel with more frontend polish.
- Visual QA pass in Xcode — light mode, all 5 accent colors, on a real simulator.